

Return of the Warlock

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RETURN OF THE WARLOCK

ABOUT THIS MODULE

Return of the Warlock is designed for 4-6 level 2nd-3rd level PCs and non-evil alignment, a good balance of character classes is advised. It takes place in the Forgotten Realms, in the Dessarin Vale, as described in The Storm King's Thunder and Princes of the Apocalypse. The module can be run using any setting where you'd find a small village and woodland mountains nearby. All encounters can easily be modified to fit either a larger or a smaller party.

When an old nemesis of the retired adventuring party Banner of the Scales returns from the dead and kidnaps the child of one the party's members, the member, Garmund, cleric of Kelemvor, turns to the PCs and asks them to help him get the boy back. Their mission will take them south along the Long Road, where they will encounter starved goblins, shadows, wights and see darkness grow over Kryptgarden forest.

This book is meant for the Dungeon Master and refers the Player's Handbook, Dungeon Master's Guide, Monster Manual, Volo's Guide to Monsters, Xanathar's Guide to Everything, Prince's of the Apocalypsel and The Storm King's Thunder. Spells and items are described in the Player's Handbook, magic items can be found in Dungeon Master's

Guide and stat blocks for monsters and villains are in the Monster Manual, unless otherwise noted.

Return of the Warlock is the 2nd installment in the Darkness over Kryptgarden adventure path. The first part, *Tomb of the Dwarven Prince*, is available on dmsguild.com.

ADVENTURE BACKGROUND

The adventuring party Banner of the Scales was formed in Shadowdale in 1469 DR by a young cleric and a devout follower of Kelemvor, Garmund. He teamed up with Anabel Steelhammer, a dwarven druid, Ceras Dolan, human fighter, Yiriala Greenleaf, a half-elf bard, and Maron Arvelia, a tiefling sorcerer. The group set out from Shadowdale to fight the undead.

A year later the group encountered a dark and evil half-elf warlock, the Thayan Kirial Del'Frair, for the first time in the city Proskur, in the Heartlands. Unbeknown to Garmund and the rest of the adventuring party, Yiriala and Kirial are siblings and have the same elven father. After discovering that the warlock was robbing graves, disturbing the dead and collecting their bones for his morbid experiments, the party decided to confront him. They fought through his skeleton minions and finally found where Kirial



had made his lair in the hills not far from the city. The warlock however was nowhere to be found, and the only clue they had was a letter from another Thayan in Elturel.

The Banner of the Scales travelled across the Heartlands and reached Elturel as winter's first snow fell. Their investigation in Elturel was fruitless and after spending the winter in the city the group decided to sail west along the River Chionthar and visit Baldur's gate.

But when they reached the Gate, they heard that the undead had been sighted in the Trollbark forest, north of Baldur's Gate. After making a brief stop in the city the party headed out once more, eager to fight the evil undead of the forest.

Once the party reached the woods they discovered that Kirial was there as well, trying to find The Warlock's Crypt, hoping to find some of Larloch's treasure. Kirial had grown in power and commanded the undead to attack and destroy the Banner of the Scales. The party fought the skeletons and zombies Kirial had raised and summoned, and finally caught the evil warlock. After a short battle, where Kirial managed to kill Maron, he teleported away.

The Banner of the Scales laid Maron to rest in the hills overlooking the Trollbark forest. The party ventured north to Daggerford where they signed on as caravan guards and after fighting off trolls, ogres and goblins the party came to Waterdeep as winter came from the north. The party spent the winter studying and on guard duty in the city.

As spring came Garmund urged his comrades to follow him north along the Long Road, for he had dreamt that they would find the evil warlock there, a dream he believed Kelemvor sent to him. The party reluctantly agreed and followed the cleric north.

Once they reached Amphail they learned that skeleton and zombies had been sighted south of Kryptgarden forest. The party investigated and found that Kirial had claimed an old tower as his lair, which he called Ravenhold. The warlock's lair bordered between the Shadowfell and the prime material plane and was very hard to enter. The party fought the warlock and his minions. The battle was hard and Ceras was killed by a powerful lightning bolt. Finally the party managed to surround Kirial at the top of the tower.

"I will return," Kirial screamed as he realized that his days as the evil commander of the undead in the tower were over, "I will return and ruin everything you hold dear. Everything you love will wither and die before your eyes."

Garmund brought forth a scroll with a very powerful spell and summoned a pillar of flame, that engulfed and killed the warlock, leaving only burned and charred remains.

After the fight the party laid Ceras to rest near Red Larch. Yiriala and Garmund travelled north, all the way to Ten Towns before coming back more than a decade later and settling in Triboar village, with Olaf, their son.

Anabel, however, stayed behind and made her home in the fields north of Amphail, where she has helped the farmers and erected her own circle of stones.

RECENT DEVELOPMENTS

A few months ago the Alhoon Val'Xootiz and his retinue of warlocks and warmongers came to Kryptgarden forest through the Underdark and, in the dragon's absence, took over Old Gnawbone's (or Claugiyliamatar) lair in Deeping Cave. Old Gnawbone left early summer to meddle with and watch how the affair with the giants unfolded. She also spent a few weeks in Waterdeep, tending to her affairs.

Recently their evil influence has been tainting the forest and all the inhabitants of the woods have felt their presence. Even the goblins are starving, since game has retreated and other sylvan creatures have moved southwards. Until now only the inhabitants of the forest have been aware of the changes in the forest.

Val'Xootiz found the remains of Kirial in Ravenhold and raised him as a warlock-wight (see appendix). Kirial has retained some of the magical powers he had in life and although being bound to Val'Xootis, his thirst for revenge against the Banner of the Scales is great.

Val'Xootis tasked Kirial with enlarging its army of undead and restore Ravenhold. Kirial didn't wait and started attacking adventurers and later caravans from Amphail, as his horde of zombies grew. But once the warlock-wight discovered that Garmund, the cleric who killed him, lived in Triboar with Yiriala, Kirial was consumed with thirst for vengeance. Kirial has also discovered where Anabel lives and where Ceras was buried.

Val'Xootiz has however tightened its grip on Kryptgarden forest. The sylvan creatures that lived there have either fled or been killed, game has fled and the goblin tribes that live in the forest have either fallen under the Alhoon's spell or are starving.

The Blackshield clan have until now resisted the Alhoon's lure but the clan is starving, hungrier than



ever before and winter is coming. Therefore the clan's leaders, Mirka and Grash, decide to gather a warband and attack the village Westbridge and steal whatever they can carry.

ADVENTURE OVERVIEW

While the PCs sit in the Northshield house a dark figure appears. It threatens Garmund and kidnaps Olaf. The Kelemvor cleric turns to the PCs and pleads for their help. He asks them to ride ahead and find his druid friend, Anabel, in Amphail and ask her to meet him and Yiriala at Ceras' grave in 15 days.

As the PCs travel south along the Long Road they happen to be in Westbridge when the Blackshield warband attacks. As the goblins fight and steal everything they can, the PCs discover that the goblins are also kidnapping children. Once the attack has passed, the people of the town beg the PCs to follow the goblins and rescue the children they took away. If they decide to help the village, it will delay them.

However, every moment counts, for Kirial attacks Anabel eight days after the attack on Garmund. If they come in time, they will meet Kirial. If they are too late, they will find Anabel dead along with many people in Amphail.

Whether the PCs manage to reach Amphail in time or not, they will need to find Garmund and Yiriala at Ceras' grave. Once there they discover that the grave has been defiled and Ceras' bodily remains removed. Shadows, summoned by Kirial, wait for any of the three members of the Banner of the Scales to come to the grave.

GETTING THE PCs INVOLVED

Whether the PCs are entering town or just wandering about they hear a commotion from Othovir's Harness Shop, with a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check**. As they get closer they see where two thugs (see MM p. 350) exit the shop, carrying young boy, perhaps 10 years old, between them. One of the thugs takes a whip and gets ready to beat the boy. The ruffians are former members of the Redbrand gang, which terrorized the village Phandalin earlier that summer. The boy, Olaf, heard the gang threaten Othovir, the harness maker, and stepped in to help the merchant.

You pass the The Cart and Coin, and hear a shrill scream. You look around and see where two men carry a young boy from a hut, not far from where you stand. The men are unshaved and dressed in

worn leather armors. One of them takes a whip from his belt and lets it crack just above the boy's head.

If the PCs decide to step in, the two thugs quickly call for help. There are two more thugs inside the shop. The thugs extort Orthovir and try to make him pay "toll for protection." Their leader, a mountain of a man called Asmir, wastes no time and orders the PCs to move along in the high-pitched voice of a 4-year-old. All the thugs are armed with whips, clubs and daggers. They are self-confident and arrogant, believing that not many people in this small village have the courage to stand up to them.

If the PCs use violence or cast spells that are either loud or flashy, the Lord Protector Darathra will arrive on the scene in 2 minutes. Darathra will be angry and demand to know what was going on.

If the PCs wish to intimidate the thugs they can with a successful **DC 16 Charisma (Intimidation) check**. If the PCs frighten or coax the thugs to leave the scene Olaf will be very grateful, thank them over and over again and proclaim to anyone in the village that they are true heroes, just like the ones that the bard and minstrels from Waterdeep sing about. The PCs have advantage on the first Charisma based check in Triboar. Othovir will also thank them, and tell the PCs these thugs arrived a few days ago and have been quite bothersome of late. Garmund will also hear about what the PCs did and go out of his way to thank them for stepping in. If the characters have been through the Lost Tomb of the Dwarven Prince, they recognize Garmund. Garmund will introduce the young boy as his son, Olaf, and say that the boy has the just heart and courage of his mother, Yiriala. But Garmund hopes that Olaf will take on his duties later on, donning the cloak of a Doomguide, a devoted priest to Kelemvor, Lord of the Dead.

If the PCs wish to parley with the thugs, they can with a successful **DC 14 Charisma (Persuasion) check** and paying 10 gps. If the PCs pay the thugs to leave both Olaf and Othovir will eye the group warily. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that neither Othovir nor Olaf think much of their actions. Othovir thanks them and tells them that the thugs have been a trouble lately but he refuses to reimburse the PCs.

If the PCs decide to lie or deceive the thugs in any way, with a successful **DC 12 Charisma (Deception) check** they manage to fool the thugs. Reward clever thinking.

If the PCs fight and kill the thugs the Lord Protector



won't take that kindly, for as Darathra, the Lord Protector says, murder is murder, despite who you murder. She will, along with men from the local militia place the PCs under arrest. Both Olaf and Othovir can testify on the PCs behalf.

If the PCs fight and defeat the thugs without killing them, Darathra will thank the PCs and view them as friends. She will recommend the Northshield House.

If the PCs are defeated by the thugs or decide to do nothing, Olaf will return to his father, Garmund, with bleeding wounds on his back from a beating.



IN TRIBOAR

LATE IN THE ROTTING - YEAR OF THE SCARLET WITCH

The PCs meet Kirial for the first time as the Warlock-Wight kidnaps the boy Olaf. They also hear the story of Garmund's adventuring party, Banner of the Scales and how the party fought and killed Kirial. Finally the PCs need to find their way south along the Long Road.

IN NORTHSHIELD HOUSE

The PCs sit in the cozy common room of the Northshield House inn, late autumn. They are resting after their last adventure and enjoying a well-earned mug of ale and food. As the night falls it starts snowing outside and a breeze picks up from the north. If a PC wishes to perform while the PCs are in the Northshield House Urgala is more than willing to allow them to, saying that they can keep whatever they earn from the other guests. With a successful **DC 12 Charisma (Performance) check** the PC earns 5 sp, for every point the PC scores above the set DC it earns 1 sp from the other guests of the inn.

The cleric of Kelemvor, Garmund, and his son, Olaf, are on their way back home when a dark clad figure, the warlock-wight Kirial, appears before them. It grabs Olaf and starts draining the boy's life, with its read eyes fixed upon Garmund.

Read or paraphrase the following:

The common room of the Northshield House is cozy and warm, and especially since you've just returned to Triboar after your last journey. Fire burns in the hearth, casting flickering shadows on the panelclad walls. Urgala, the Turami innkeeper, is busy bringing large dishes and bowls with roasted meat and boiled vegetables, the rich smell brings water to your mouth. Her helping hand, a blond teenage girl called Jenna, moves from table to table and makes sure that the few guests staying at the inn have enough to drink. This late in the Rotting the tide of caravans has mostly passed Triboar and you know that soon it will start to snow, the cold rushing from the north, making travel along the Long Road hard.

You lean back, feel the tension in your muscles slowly relax as dusk falls over the village. Urgala brings another tray of meat and vegetables. As she places the tray on your table, the air seemingly grows colder and the shadows seem to grow darker. The air grows thick with arcane power and a faint rotting odor makes you cringe.

Urgala looks bewildered at you, then she straightens up and looks around the common room. The guests stand up, all have felt the strange tension in the air.



With a successful **DC 14 Intelligence (Religion) check** the PCs relate this change to the undead. As soon as the PCs decide to act, they hear scream coming from outside.

Continue reading:

Suddenly a shrill scream cuts through the night. Everyone inside the Northshield House freeze before their eyes turn to you.

If the PCs decide to investigate this further, read or paraphrase the following.

Outside snow is falling and a gentle breeze blows from the north. A dark figure stands in the middle of the road just outside the Northshield House, holding the young acolyte Olaf with one hand. His face is ashen and the eyes rolled back. Garmund is not far away, down on his knees and pleading.

"Please, Kirial, please, take me, don't kill my boy," the Doomguide cries.

The dark figure sniggers.

"I told you I would return," it hisses, its voice cold and dry, "I promised that I would make you suffer, that everything you've ever loved would turn to ashes. Just as you left me in ashes."

Garmund's face grows hard and he grabs the holy symbol of Kelemvor hanging in a leather strap around his neck. He raises the golden scales, faith burning in his gray eyes.

"Ner'ia Hel," the dark figure says and waves its hand. In a flash of light it and Olaf disappear.

A bolt of searing light streaks across the street and hits a house.

"No, Olaf!" Garmund cries out, then falls again to his knees.

With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs know that the dark figure, Kirial, used some sort of teleport spell.

If the PCs decide to talk to Garmund he is heartbroken and crying. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs feel that the cleric must be in some kind of shock. If the PCs don't think of bringing Garmund in, Urgala, who stands in the door of the Northshield House, proposes that the PCs do so.

GARMUND'S STORY

As soon as Garmund is in the Northshield House Jenna brings him a warm cup of starleaf-tea. Urgala sends after the Lord Protector Darathra. Garmund

grabs the teacup with both hands shaking. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs see that Garmund is in shock. He mumbles something to himself and keeps repeating the same words. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs can make out the words Kirial, Ravenhold, Yiriala and Anabel. With a successful **DC 18 Intelligence (History) check** the PCs recognize Ravenhold as a ruined tower in the southern parts of Kryptgarden forest.

If the PCs wish to speak to Garmund before the Lord Protector arrives, they need to calm the Doomguide down. With a successful **DC 14 Charisma (Persuasion) check** the PCs manage to calm the cleric down and get him to talk.

"He took Olaf, I don't understand this," Garmund says, "I watched Kirial burn. How could he return? What..." Garmund hides his face in his shaky hands. "He just appeared in the middle of the road. I was... I couldn't..." Garmund looks up to you, his eyes filled with tears. "I can't believe he's back. How could he return? And he took Olaf, my dear boy." He wipes a tear from his brow. "By all the good gods, what will Yiriala say?" Garmund's body trembles and he falls down on his knees before you and raises his arms, almost forming a scale with his body. "Oh, Kelemvor, lord of dead, watch over my son, protect him and help me... help me bring him back to his mother."

If the PCs wish to speak to Garmund, he is much calmer after his prayer to Kelemvor. He seems to come to his senses, as much as one in his position can, and can answer the PCs questions.

If the PCs don't ask Garmund questions, Lord Protector Darathra will when she arrives.

Can you tell us what happened:

We were walking home, I took Olaf to see the apothecary, here across the street. I've been teaching him and I wanted him to learn about potions, I've been hoping that he will take over my duties later. When we were at the intersection suddenly in a flash of light, there he was. Kirial. The warlock. The cold that emanated from him was breathtaking. He pushed me away, grabbed Olaf and seemed to suck the life out of my boy, with the mere touch of his hand. I was so shocked I couldn't move a leg. I couldn't believe he was back. I tried to speak up, but I was utterly stiff, like a statue. Before I could do anything he was gone again.



With a successful **DC 14 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs suspect that Garmund was under the effect of a spell. If the PCs ask about what Kirial said, Garmund has no recollection of anything Kirial said, in fact, he is a bit taken back hearing that he was under the warlock's spell. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Religion) check** the PCs recognize that Kirial might be undead.

Who is Kirial?

Many years ago I was a part of an adventuring party called The Banner of Scales. The party was formed in Shadowdale, where I am from, in the Year of the Splendors Burning and we set out to fight the undead and do Kelemvor's work. A year later we first encountered the Thayan Kirial Del'Fraai, a half-elven warlock raising the dead in Proskur's graveyard. We fought his undead but he got away. In 1471 DR we encountered him again in Trollbark forest, just north of Baldur's Gate, and after a bloody battle, where one of our friends died, Kirial got away again. After spending the winter in the city of Splendors we headed out north along the Long Road. In Amphail we heard that the undead had been sighted in the southern part of Kryptgarden Forest. We found Kirial there, where he had made his lair. We fought and finally managed to defeat him. I called forth a pillar of Kelemvor's holy flame and burned the warlock for his sinful treatment of the dead. The warlock's final words were: I will return and make you all suffer! Now he has.

With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Nature) check** the PCs recognize Proskur as a city in the Heartlands, where thieves guilds rule supreme. The graveyard is in the hills just north of the city. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs recognize the spell as *Flame Strike*. With a successful **DC 10 Intelligence (History) check** the PCs know that the Year of the Splendors Burning was 1469 DR or over 20 years ago.

If the PCs ask about the fate of the Banner of the Scales, Garmund will tell them what happened to Maron and Ceras, and where they can find Anabel. Garmund will also tell the PCs that he and Yiriala joined another adventuring party, Pride of Mirabar, that disbanded some years ago. Garmund and Yiriala settled in Neverwinter, where Olaf was born. They moved to Triboar a couple of years ago, since Yiriala wanted to be closer to nature than the city could ever offer her.

What is Ravenhold?

Ravenhold is the old tower where Kirial made his lair, in the southern part of Kryptgarden forest, about 3 days east of Red Larch. The tower was probably built by dwarves of some long forgotten kingdom, since it was sturdy and had a dungeon beneath it. The warlock had trapped many sylvan creatures beneath it and seemed to be syphoning their life energy for some evil and foul purposes. Last time I was there most of Ravenhold stood on the border between Toril and the Shadowfell, the dark reflection of our plane, and the only way to enter it was to disguise ourselves as Kirial. The gatekeeper is an automaton of some sort, and it only let the warlock and those accompanied by him enter the tower.

With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (History) check** the PCs feel that the tower might date back to the time of the Besilmer kingdom. If the PCs ask about the sylvan creatures, Garmund tells them that Kirial held a dryad captive along with a couple of satyr. The life of the creatures seemed to be slowly draining from them through some foul sorcery. With successful **DC 24 Intelligence (Arcane) check** the PCs suspect that this might be a part of the warlock's ritual to master the *Defy death* power (see Sward Coast Adventurer's Guide p. 140). With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs know that the Shadowfell is the plane of shadows, where the undead are even more powerful.

Other Questions:

Garmund will try his best to answer the PCs questions, see the adventure background. He does not know where Kirial is now or how he returned from death. He knows nothing about the alhoon in Kryptgarden forest, he does not know if Anabel, the dwarven druid of Banner of the Scales, knows about Kirial's return.

If the Lord Protector is there, she will also ask Garmund a few questions regarding the Banner of the Scales, e.g. who were in the adventuring party and where are they now? Do they need to be warned?

GARMUND AND YIRIALA ASK FOR HELP

When the PCs have asked all their questions, Yiriala enters the Northshield House. Her hair is wild, there's a wild, frantic look in her eyes and the moment she lays her eyes on Garmund she starts crying. A couple of the Lord Protector's guard take up position by the door. Read or paraphrase the following:



The door to the Northshield House opens, and cold wind and snow rushes in. The fire in the fireplace flickers and a few candles go out. A female half-elf, wearing green shirt and brown pants enters the inn's common room, followed by two armed men of the local militia. Her eyes bear the color of her elven lineage, golden and captivating. The woman seems to be in her late thirties, she wears her hair in a braid in the fashion of the married women in these parts. Soon as she sees Garmund she runs over to him. Garmund stands up and takes the half-elf into his arms.

"I can't believe he's back. How could he? We watched him die," the half-elf says. She looks up to Garmund before taking a step back and looking around. "Where's Olaf?" she asks. Garmund opens his mouth, then closes it again and reaches out to her. The half-elf woman's eyes well up with tears. "No, please, no! Don't tell me..."

"Yiriala, my dear...", Garmund stutters and grabs Yiriala. He pulls her in close. "He took him. He took our boy."

After a few moments, Yiriala breaks free from Garmund. Her eyes burn with fire and she clenches her fists.

"We're going after him. I'm not leaving my son with that monster," she says. Her body is tense. She looks around in the room. "Who amongst you has honor? Who amongst you here will come to aid a mother? Who amongst you has a good heart and the courage to do what's right?"

Yiriala and Garmund have no money to pay mercenaries or adventurers for their help. If the PCs try to bargain with them and ask for money, Urgala scowls. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs feel that the innkeeper thinks little of the PCs. If the PCs insist on getting paid, Lord Protector Darathra offers to pay them 100 gp's each for their trouble, and adds, disapproval dripping off every word: "...if money is all you care for!"

If the PCs still refuse to help Garmund and Yiriala they will turn to other guests, which are mostly merchants and travellers. Each and every one will excuse themselves, leaving the couple alone to deal with the warlock. If the PCs still refuse to act, the word quickly spreads through the village. The PCs have a disadvantage to any Charisma based check for the next month and prices for rooms at inns will double.

If the PCs agree on helping Garmund and Yiriala, they plan and discuss what to do deep into the night.

Yiriala can add to Garmund's answers (see adventure background) and she also knows much about the Dessarin Vale (she has +8 modifier to Intelligence (History)). Yiriala can draw the PCs a map of where to find Caser's burial mound and Anabel's hut, if they wish. She and Garmund can also tell the PCs that Kirial while still living was a dangerous warlock who preferred to use darkness in fights, making him almost impossible to hit, though being in magical darkness didn't seem to have any negative effect on him (see Kirial in appendix). His eldritch blasts were also quite deadly.

You sit down by the fire and Urgala has wine, ale and tea brought to your table. As the innkeeper sits down beside Lord Protector Darathra Garmund speaks up.

"Thank you all, for offering your help. I," he says and looks to his wife, "we hope that one day we will be able to repay you." The light from the candles in the middle of the table dance on his golden holy symbol.

Yiriala takes his hand. The Doomguide sighs and opens his mouth to say something, but stops and looks down.

Urgala turns to face each of you, her face stern. "You adventurers, what do you propose? How would you like to handle this?"

Give the PCs a chance to discuss this among themselves and ask Garmund, Yiriala and Darathra more questions. Darathra also asks a few questions, though mostly aimed at the PCs, in an effort to discern if the PCs are aligned with the Zhentarim. With a successful **DC 16 Charisma (Deception) check** the PCs manage to deceive the Lord Protector, if they are members of the Black Network. If they are members of the Harpers and in any way let Darathra know, she will offer to aid them in any way possible.

Ravenhold is the most logical place to start their search for Kirial, since it was the warlock's last known lair. It will take days to travel to the southern part of Kryptgarden forest. Garmund and Yiriala are eager to investigate the old keep, but are hesitant to do it without the aid of their friends.

As the night wears on, Garmund and Yiriala say that they would like to warn Anabel and have her meet them by Caser's grave in fifteen days. They kindly ask the PCs to do so, because they would like to have as much help as possible before venturing into Ravenhold, should the warlock be there. Anabel lives in a small hut an hour's ride north of the village Amphail, south of Triboar. With a successful **DC 13**



Intelligence (Nature) check the PCs know that it will take more than a tenday to walk from Triboar to Amphail. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs also know, taking the season into account, that foraging and sleeping outdoors is not easy. If the PCs propose that they can ride south, Garmund will draw them a small map showing where to find Anabel's hut (show the PC's handout #1). Garmund asks the PCs to bring Anabel to Caser's burial mound, two days west from Red Larch, and meet him and Yiriala there.

Garmund and Yiriala plan to go to Phandalin to enlist the aid of a long-time friend of theirs, Daran Edermath (see the Lost Mines of Phandalin). There they also plan on getting Kirial's magical items which they hid in Phandalin, *Robe of Eyes* and *Wand of Paralysis*, which they need to complete their disguise to enter Ravenhold.

If the PCs wish to accompany Garmund and Yiriala they are free to, though Garmund repeats his wish in having Anabel warned, for he fears for her safety. Urgala also weighs in and says that it would be best if the team split up. If the PCs insist, Darathra proposes that she can send a rider south to Amphail to warn the druid. If the PCs choose to go with Garmund and Yiriala the trip is mostly uneventful, safe for Westbridge being ransacked and troubled after the goblin attack a few days earlier (see below). Anabel will not meet the group by Caser's grave.

When the PCs have asked all their questions and planned their trip, Urgala invites them to stay for free for the night. Garmund and Yiriala go back to their cottage and Darathra leaves as well. Before leaving Darathra asks the PCs to find her in the Lord's Tower before they leave next morning.

LEAVING TRIBOAR

Urgala wakes the PCs up an hour before dawn. It has snowed during the night but the weather is still and Selune shines high above. Breakfast is served in the common room, oatmeal, boiled eggs, freshly baked bread and warm milk.

As soon as the PCs are ready to move out, read or paraphrase the following:

You step out into the cold as the sun rises over the Dessarin hills. Somewhere east along the Evermoor way waits the city Yartar, homebase of the Lionshield Coster merchant company, and Everlund and Silverymoon even further east, by the Nether Mountains. Urgala hands each of you a small satchel with bread and dried meat.

"Go now, friends, and may Tymora smile upon you." She tugs her shawl close. "It might snow

some more, so I suggest you make haste." Urgala smiles and enters her inn again.

The village is slowly waking up, the merchants are opening their stores and people are starting to go about. The PCs can go shopping in Triboar before leaving, though no magical items can be bought, save for 3 Potions of Healing which Tarmock Felaskur, the apothecary, has brewed (See Storm King's Thunder p. 53-60).

While shopping and talking to the locals the PCs might hear some of the things the locals are talking about. Most are in shock over the news of Garmund's and Yiriala's son, Olaf. They are generally well liked and the boy is known by most of the villagers. Few others, mostly hunters and rangers, are speaking about the lack of game in Kryptgarden forest these days.

If the PCs decide to talk to Darathra they can find her in the Lord Protector's Tower in the middle of the Market Square.

Read or paraphrase the following:

A simple two-story stone tower serves as the base for the Lord Protector Darathra Shendrel. The tower leans to the east and above the entrance is an old battered banner depicting three black boars on a blood-red field.

Darathra sits by a large desk and writes something down in her leather-clad ledger. As soon as the PCs enter the tower she looks up and stops writing. She will stand up and greet the PCs, asking them how they slept and if they have had breakfast yet.

Darathra has arranged horses for PCs and they only need to speak to Arn Widdens in The Cart and Coin, just across the square. Darathra also warns the PCs, for she has heard that the barbarian tribes are on the move.

Joining the Harpers

If there are no Harpers in the group but one or more of the PCs have expressed themselves as good-aligned, Darathra will kindly ask any such PC to speak privately with her. She will tell the PC about those who harp and invite the PC to join the Harpers. If the PC agrees then Darathra will recite the Code of the Harpers and will offer to be the PC patron while the PC is learning the ropes. Darathra will say that this quest for Garmund and Yiriala is a good start for beginning Harpers. She will hand the PC a small medallion with the Harpers' insignia, before bidding them farewell.



AT THE CART AND COIN

The Cart and Coin is mostly a large stable, where half a dozen workers go about feeding and taking care of the many horses and draft animals. The establishment is run by a couple, Arn and Syreen Widdens, and they have a large stable and a small house beside it where they live. When the PCs arrive there are 5 Redbrand thugs trying to bully the Widdens to hand over horses. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs hear angry voices coming from the Cart and Coin. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs also hear someone crying.

If the PCs decide to investigate this, read or paraphrase the following:

Three armed men stand over a group of people sitting in the middle of the stable. A middle aged man holds his arms over the shoulders of a crying woman. A large man leads five horses from the stable. By the sound of it, someone is also in the small hut beside the large stable rummaging through closets and drawers.

"Take what you need, you thrice damned brigands, and begone with you," the middle aged man says

through clenched teeth.

"Don't worry, Widdens, we will. Jackie there," one of the armed men says and points to the hut, "just needs to find where you stashed your summer earning. After all, we need to eat just as you do."

If the PCs dealt with the thugs that were bullying Olaf and Orthovir by scaring them off and not used any violence, these are the same thugs and in no mood for talking. The moment the PCs enter the courtyard they draw weapons.

If the PCs had the other thugs arrested one of these thugs will recognize them and tell the others, which will all draw weapons, eager to get back at the PCs.

Three minutes after the fight starts Darathra will arrive and start asking questions. Arn and Syreen along with the workers can all testify on the PCs behalf and will tell Darathra that the PCs came to their rescue.

If the PCs take steps in order to arrest the thugs and bring them to justice, award any lawful-aligned PC Inspiration.

Few minutes after the fight Arn has calmed his wife and orders his workers to get back to work and clean up the mess after the thugs. In a half-an-hour or so the PCs can have their horses and riding animals. If they decide to help cleaning up the mess they will get the horses sooner and have an advantage on any Charisma based checks with the Widdens.



ENROUTE TO AMPHAIL

The PCs head out of Triboar to search for Anabel, the dwarven druid and friend of Garmund and Yiriala, to warn her of Kirial's return. They are also to bring her message to meet Garmund and Yiriala by Caser's burial mound in two tendays. The PCs learn about the the goblin tribe Blackshield's attack in Westbridge and are besieged by the people of the small town to rescue their children from the goblins. The PCs keep travelling south along the Long Road, until they reach Amphail.

ENROUTE TO WESTBRIDGE

The distance from Triboar to Westbridge is about 80 miles and due to snow it's safe to assume that the PCs can't ride at full speed the whole time. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs find a suitable spot to spend the night.

The weather is typical for late autumn, early winter, rain turns to sleet and the days are cold. The PCs need to be well equipped and dressed in warm clothes. During the night the temperature drops even lower and the PCs need to have good woolen blankets and build a decent fire to keep them warm.

The nights are dark and perfect for predators, bandits and other evil beings. Roll for random encounters as often as you see fit.

LONG ROAD ENCOUNTERS

Travellers along the Long Road at this time of year can encounter wandering monsters and other travellers. Use the following table to determine random encounters. Such encounters can occur as often as you see fit, but remember that too many random encounters will slow the progress of the story. Each encounter is described in more detail below.

For guidance on how to use random encounters, see chapter 3 in DMG.

Roll d20	Encounter
1-2	Bandits
3-4	Crag Cats
5-6	Flock of Ravens
7-8	Caravan
9-10	Orc Warband
11-12	Knight of Tyr
13-14	Ogre
15-16	Peryton
17-18	Pack of Wolves
19-20	Satyr



BANDITS

A gang of Redbrand bandits ambush the PCs on the Long Road. The gang consists of a **Bandit leader** (See MM p. 344) and 2d4+2 **bandits** (see MM p. 343). The Bandit leader will try to press the PCs to hand over all their gold, for a safe passage. If the PCs refuse the bandits will attack. If the PCs defeat 50% of the bandit group the rest tries to flee.

Crag Cats

A group of 3 **Crag Cats** (see SKT p. 240) hides and attempts to surprise the party. The cats have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks.

FLOCK OF RAVENS

A flock of 2d10+3 the warlock's ravens (use the Bloodhawk entry MM p. 319) circle above the party and attack. The flock attacks relentlessly until the flock has lost half of their number.

CARAVAN

The PCs pass one of the late caravans returning to Waterdeep, the caravan consists of 8 wagons, their merchants and 12 guards. The caravan leader, Maree Firemane (NG female half-elf fighter), is not eager to stop the caravan since winter is fast approaching. If the PCs wish to join her caravan, she agrees to it, but says that she can't pay them.

ORC Warband

A band of 7 **orcs** (see MM p. 246) and 1 **orog** (see MM p. 247) ambushes the party and attack. The warband, a part of the Crimson Hand clan off Evermoor has 2d4 skinny goblin prisoners, captured in Kryptgarden Forest. Once freed, the goblins make haste back to the forest. The orcs also have 3 gps, 28 sps and 35 cps and one *Potion of Vitality*.

KNIGHT OF TYR

Jikan Halathar, a **knight** (see MM p. 347) of Tyr, is riding towards Mirabar along the Long Road. Jikan is fully armored and so is his **warhorse** (see MM p.340), which has chainmail barding. Jikan's task is to bring a message from the church in Waterdeep to the congregation in the mining city in the north. Jikan is eager to hear news from the Triboar and asks the

PCs about the Lord Protector, what's she's like etc. However, he warns the PCs that he was attacked by undead north of the Red Larch.

OGRE

The **ogre** (see MM p. 237) Leepaloode, after spending the summer under the bridge over the stream in the Black Maw Bog (see Tomb of the Dwarven Prince), harassing travellers and caravans, has decided to move south. He is travelling with his young daughter, Skiellebyalla (use the stats for **half-ogre**, but only armed with a javelin, see MM p. 238), and will defend her to the death. However, he isn't all too keen on fighting, since he has earned enough gold to support himself and his daughter. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that fight might be avoided. If the PCs show no intention of fighting or threatening Leepaloode or Skiellebyalla, the pair simply moves on and leaves the party alone. If the PCs defeat Leepaloode and Skiellebyalla they have 85 gps worth of jewellery and 92 gps in a brown, foul-smelling leather bag.

PERYTON

A hungry **peryton** (see MM p. 251), having not been able to find a suitable prey for days since the alhoon has made hunting in the woods along the Sword Mountains almost impossible the predator flies every further from its mountain nest. The Peryton dives in and attacks any elves, half-elves or humans in the party first. The Peryton is very hungry and will fight to the death.

PACK OF WOLVES

A large pack of **wolves** (see MM p. 341) picks up the party's scent and is curious to see if there some food to be had there. With a successful **DC 15 Charisma (Animal Handling) check** the PCs manage to convince the wolves not to attack and stay away. If the check fails by 5 or more, the pack attacks once the PCs slow down, either to rest or make camp. The pack has 2d12+2 wolves. It will fight relentlessly until half their number has been killed or chased away.

SATYR

A single **satyr** (see MM p. 267) watches the road. The satyr, Hildir, is looking for the Whisper, a unicorn forest lord, chosen by Mielikki to watch over



the southern part of Kryptgarden forest. Whisper is being held captive in Ravenhold. If the PCs stop to speak to Hildir, he will tell them about his quest to find Whisper and how Kryptgarden forest has changed during the summer. Hildir knows that Old Gnawbone is gone, though he doesn't know where the dragon is or why it disappeared. Whisper is being held in prison in Ravenhold.

APPROACHING WESTBRIDGE

When the PCs are about 3 miles outside of Westbridge, they see a goblin patrol. This is a scout party from the Blackshield tribe, which is attacking and ransacking Westbridge, in hope of finding enough food to survive the winter. The goblins are so starved they grab anything they can carry, including children. The scout party, 7 **goblins** (see MM p.166) riding **Worgs** (see MM p. 341), have orders to attack anyone that looks dangerous or carries a weapon. Read or paraphrase the following:

The shadows are getting longer and the thought of not sleeping outside in the snow is on your mind. Westbridge is not far away and you should reach it before nightfall.

With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs spot the goblins before the goblins see them.

On a small hill about 180 feet away from you, you notice 7 riders. The riders don't seem to have noticed you. As you look closer you see that the riders are not riding horses, but worgs.

With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Nature) check** the PCs know that goblins often use worgs as mounts. If the PCs wish to scout the situation, with a successful **DC 15 Dexterity (Stealth) check** the PCs crawl closer and see that there are 7 goblin riders on worgs, all armed to the teeth. Yet their bodies are skinny and the worgs seem skittish.

If the PCs wish to avoid fighting the goblins they can go around the goblins. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Survival) check** and a successful **DC 12 Dexterity (Stealth) check** the PCs find a trail that leads them around the goblin patrol and into Westbridge unnoticed. If the PCs decide to bring the horses along the Dexterity (Stealth) check is made at an disadvantage.

If the PCs do not notice the goblins the two groups spot each other simultaneously when they are 100 ft apart. The goblins charge and attack.

If the PCs decide to attack the goblins and spot the goblins before the goblins spot the PCs, they have a surprise round when they are 150 ft apart.

If the PCs defeat or kill half of the goblins the rest disengages and flees. If the PCs capture a goblin and interrogate it, with a successful **DC 14 Charisma (Intimidation) check** the goblin confesses in heavily accented Common that their leader, Drungi Blackshield, summoned all the warriors and decided to attack the village, since he was sure that the villagers would have enough food for the clan to survive the winter. The clan is starving, since game and woodland creatures have fled the Kryptgarden forest since late summer.

As soon as the battle ends, a shrill sound of a horn echoes from the village. The goblin leaders call of the attack and hurry towards the forest with their loot.

As you are cleaning your weapons you hear the shrill and clear sound of a horn. In the dusk you see where numerous small creatures hurry from the village, many of them carrying something or are being pulled or lead on. Smoke rises from two buildings in the village.

The goblins have left Westbridge in complete chaos. The small militia is beaten, scarred and exhausted, not to mention utterly demoralized. A couple of buildings are on fire and since the half-elf militia leader, Erna Harrowen, was slain in the battle the members of the militia have no idea on what is the next course of action.

IN WESTBRIDGE

Westbridge is a small village along the Long Road. A large inn stands by the road, The Harvest Inn, which is run by the halfling Herivin Dardragon (see Storm King's Thunder p. 114). In the town center there is a small market, in one corner is a stockyard and a couple of granaries. The village is in uproar and disarray after the attack of the Blackshield goblin tribe. The villagers are tending to their wounded, crying for help and trying to muster some able people together to go after the goblins and save the children the Blackshields kidnapped.

As you enter the small town the smell of burning wood fills the air, panicked shouts and cries of the wounded echo in the falling dusk. The village is in complete chaos, fire burns in two small houses in the southern end of the town, casting dancing shadows cross the Long Road. Few people with buckets run from a small well not far from a large



three story building, decorated with a sign that says Harvest Inn. Not far from you an old woman sits weeping by the still body of a young man, a few blackened arrows protrude from the man's body. A middle aged half-elf woman, dressed in chainmail, sits by a darkened doorway in a pool of blood. She holds her hand over an ugly wound in her throat, her eyes cold and unblinking and blood no longer flowing from the wound. A dead goblin lies by her feet.

The old woman, Jara, is grieving her son, Okam, who died defending the town against the goblin marauders. She is in too much distress to be questioned. The half-elf by the door was Erna Harrowen, the militia leader. She was killed by Drungi, the leader of the Blackshield tribe, trying to prevent them from taking the children. With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Medicine) check** the PCs see that Erna was killed by multiple stabs and slashes, the wound in her neck seems to have cut through an artery and was probably the one wound that did the most damage.

Clerics and Paladins of good deities

If there are PCs who venerate the good aligned deities in Faerun, e.g. Ilmater and Tyr, this is a perfect opportunity for them to display the dogma of their gods. The town is in dire need of help, healing and support. The PCs can help with dowsing the fires, heal the wounded, contribute gold to the necessary rebuilding. If they do, award those PCs with Inspiration.

If the PCs wish to help the people of Westbridge, the villagers are mostly in shock or busy trying to put out the fires in the two small houses on the other side of the town. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs spot a halfling, Herivin Dardragon, in a blood spattered shirt running around, speaking with the villagers and seemingly trying to organize the villagers' efforts.

If the PC decide to speak to Herivin and offer to help, he sighs in relief and thanks Tymora.

The halfling sees you coming and studies you for a while. His face is sooted and his white shirt spattered with blood. In a sheath by his belt is a shortsword, decorated with a small bloodstone in its hilt.

"Thank Tymora," he says and sighs with a relief, "we sure could use the help of able bodies like yourselves. My name is Herivin Dardragon and

I run the Harvest Inn. It's normally not like this, but goblin attacked us." He wipes his brow. "They took our younglings and much of the livestock. They headed east. I'm sure you could catch them, if you tried. Please, will you try and save them?"

The goblins kidnapped 4 children aged 3-8 years old, 6 cows and 14 sheep. The childrens' names are Evert (3 years old, male illuskan human), Cindra (5 years old, female halfling), Ali (7 years old, male chultan human) and Nora (8 years old, female half-elf).

If the PCs decide to help and act immediately, Herivin shows them where the goblins left the town. Despite the darkness a trail is visible in the wet snow. With a successful **DC 13 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs can track the trail west towards Kryptgarden forest.

If the PCs decide to help but decide to leave in the morning, the goblins have a good headstart and have taken precautions to hide their trail. With a successful **DC 16 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs manage to find the trail and track it.

If the PCs try to haggle and get Herivin to pay them, Herivin's mood darkens. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that he wasn't expecting this kind of an answer. After a short while he simply answers: "Look around you, do you think there are many coins left to spare? If you don't have the heart to help us, please leave Westbridge." Herivin isn't in the mood to haggle and argue whether the PCs should get paid for rescuing the Westbridge children. If the PCs persist he will answer: "Those who seek to profit from other people's misfortunes are not the sort I wish to do business with. Good day to you and safe travels." Herivin leaves the PCs, ignoring them if they continue to haggle and bargain.

If the PCs deny Herivin he nods his head and accepts their decision. However, if the PCs ask for room in the Harvest Inn they are treated coldly and though their money is good and well received, they should feel that both Herivin and his staff are not too eager to serve them.

Red herring

It's not unlikely that the characters feel as if there's a connection between the kidnapping of Olaf and the Blackshields' attack. There isn't, other than the goblins are starving due to the alhoon's evil influence, but the PCs shouldn't discover this until and if they capture a goblin and interrogate it, or if they parley with Drungi, the Blackshields' leader.



TRACKING THE BLACKSHIELDS

The goblins left a visible track in the snow, one that isn't too hard to follow (see above). The tribe leaves Westbridge about half an hour before the PCs arrive and have a head start. However, they have to drag along not only children but also grain in barrels and sacks, some of which they have stacked on worgs.

If the PCs make haste and start following the goblins shortly after Herivin asks them to rescue the children, the tribe is only 1 mile ahead of them. If the PCs are riding horses they should catch up with the rear guards soon enough.

If the PCs wait until morning the goblins are 6 miles ahead of the PCs. The goblins are weakened due to starvation and despite the sunlight, Drungi will push the tribe on to get to their camp in Kryptgarden forest as soon as possible, where he plans to raise both livestock and children as fodder for this tribe. With three successful **DC 16 Wisdom (Survival)** checks the PCs manage to follow the trail. If the PCs are riding horses they catch the warband's rear guard shortly after noon.

THE GOBLIN REARGUARD

Unless the PCs take precautions to not have the goblins notice them, the goblins spot them tracking the warband. Once the PCs have caught the Blackshields Drungi orders some of his warriors to take up rearguard positions and slay whoever is trailing them. When the PCs are 100 feet away from the Blackshields 8 **goblin worg** riders (see MM p. 166 and MM p. 341) break off and attack the PCs.

If the attack is near Westbridge it happens in relatively worked and even fields. If the attack is closer to Kryptgarden forest then the terrain is more rugged, large boulders, trees and shrubs can provide cover.

THE GOBLIN WARBAND

If the PCs manage to deal with the rearguard, Drungi orders his warriors to form a defensive circle around their loot, the livestock and children. There are 16 **goblin** warriors (see MM p. 166) and Drungi, a **goblin boss** (see MM p. 166), 8 goblin warriors are armed with shortbows, who have drawn their arrows. Drungi is clever enough to know where to best take up defensive position and he will try to use the terrain to the goblin's advantage. Within the circle are the children and most of the livestock,

along with three worgs loaded with grain, both in bags and barrels.

If the PCs don't attack outright, Drungi will hear them out should they wish to talk following a successful **DC 14 Charisma (Persuasion)** check. Drungi speaks heavily accented common and is smart enough to know that a fight with the PCs will not be easy and might claim the lives of more goblins.

Drungi has only one goal in mind, making sure that his tribe has enough food to survive the coming winter. He isn't too keen on letting his prisoners go and will not let the livestock go nor the grain, claiming that it is the goblins' loot which they took "fair and square". With a successful **DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion)** check the PCs manage to use diplomacy to free the children. If the PCs try to deceive or intimidate Drungi, add a +5 to the DC, since the goblins outnumber the PCs and there are many goblins there to help Drungi to see through the PCs lies and threats.

If the PCs try to persuade Drungi to give back the livestock he will say that if he does his tribe will die. If the PCs ask about the reasons Drungi will tell the PCs about the disappearance of game and sylvan races from Kryptgarden forest. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs see that Drungi is being truthful. With a successful **DC 22 Charisma (Persuasion)** check the PCs manage to convince Drungi to let go off either the sheep or the cows.

If the PCs attack the goblins will fight to the death.

Members of Emerald Enclave

Druids and other members of the Emerald Enclave, interested in keeping nature's balance, know that what Drungi is saying is a threat to that. If the goblins would die of starvation that would further the imbalance and allowing them to keep the cattle and the grain can only help keeping the balance. If there is a member of the Emerald Enclave in the group, that PC gains inspiration if the PCs negotiate with the goblins and allow the goblins to keep the grain and cattle.

If the PCs manage to either defeat the goblins and reclaim the livestock or successfully bargain for the cattle and sheep they need to herd it back to Westbridge. With a successful **DC 12 Charisma (Animal Handling)** check the PCs bring back the livestock to Westbridge.

RETURN TO WESTBRIDGE

If the PCs return to Westbridge it depends heavily on their success how well received they'll be. The



villagers eagerly await their return in the common room of the Harvest Inn. Herivin has sentries posted by the village outskirts, to bring him news if the PCs are spotted returning to Westbridge.

If the PCs bring back the children the villagers will be very happy to see them and thank the PCs wholeheartedly. The children will also see the PCs are their saviours and tell everyone about their heroics, with all the exaggerations of a child. Mothers with tears in their eyes hug and thank the PCs, crying in joy. Fathers shake the PCs hands and offer to buy them a mug of ale, for they “bloody well earned it”. Herivin will nod his approval and offer the PCs a free room to rest their weary bones.

If the PCs bring back the livestock the villagers will be thankful and Herivin brings each PC a leather pouch, as long as they also bring back the children. If the PCs do not bring the children back, the villagers will accept the livestock gloomily and leave the PCs. Herivin will sigh, his shoulders sag and with a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs feel that he had more faith in their abilities.

If the PCs bring back the grain Herivin will ask them to leave it at the grainary before finding him in the Harvest Inn. He will give them food and ale and thank them for their help. The villagers will say nothing and leave the common room in pairs and in silence. If the PCs bring back both the grain and the livestock the villagers will thank the PCs for their help but their thanks are mixed with sorrow.

If the PCs bring back all three the villagers will be ecstatic and receive the PCs as great heroes. Herivin will hand them one bag containing two bloodstones worth 50 gp each, and offer them a place to stay the night. The villagers will claim that the PCs are always welcome in Westbridge and have earned the villagers’ gratitude.

Local heroes

The PCs have earned the feature *Rustic Hospitality*, as per Folk Hero feature. The feature only works in Westbridge.

TRAVELLING TOWARDS RED LARCH

Once the PCs decide to travel further south, read or paraphrase the following:

You head out of Westbridge and south along the snow-covered Long Road. The cold breeze hurls up loose snow. Smoke rises from the homesteads

along the road and further south you see where the land rises, where the Sember hills rise above the fields.

The ride to Red Larch takes about two days. Walking there takes four days. Roll for random encounters as you see fit, using the encounter table provided above.

A DWARVEN CARAVAN

When dusk is falling the PCs spot a firelight ahead. A dwarven caravan, coming from Waterdeep and headed for Citadel Adbar, has made camp for the night. Read or paraphrase the following:

You’re sore and tired from a whole day’s ride and just as you are getting ready to find a good place for a camp you eye flickering lights further south the Long Road.

If the PCs decide to go closer, they will find a caravan full of armed dwarves, bearing the coat of arms of Citadel Adbar. With a successful **DC 14 Intelligence (History) check** the PCs recognize the symbol.

If the PCs approach the caravan camp the dwarves will quickly spot them and the guards (see MM p. 347) will call out and tell them to come no closer. If the PCs introduce themselves and ask the dwarves to share the fire, the guards call out for Uriel Darkanvil (CG female dwarf priest of Moradin, see MM p. 348). If the PCs wish to share the dwarves’ camp, with a successful **DC 13 Charisma (Persuasion) check** they convince Uriel to let them in.

The dwarves are returning back to Citadel Adbar after a successful trade meet in Waterdeep. The dwarves are merry and happy to share both fire and ale. As the night wears on the dwarves challenge the PCs to contests of strength, lift heavy barrels and stones etc. The dwarves are more than willing to bet on who will win each contest. The dwarven warriors are eager to challenge any humans to contests like these. The dwarves have a +4 in Strength (Athletics), the contests are skill checks, whoever rolls higher wins. Feel free to describe different types of contests. If the dwarves lose any of the contests, they will quickly change the nature of the contests and focus of Constitution, where the dwarves have +3 to each check.

If the PCs wish to speak to Uriel they quickly discover that she has the charms of a cold anvil. She isn’t eager to spend the evening talking to the PCs, whom she sees as just another group of travellers. She answers the PCs questions the best way she can, preferably in as few words as possible. She knows



nothing about the PCs quest nor what's happening in Kryptgarden Forest. However, if the PCs ask about anything related to the woods, she heard arumor in Waterdeep that the PCs might find interesting. She learned, while visiting the famous tavern The Yawning Portal, that some of the rangers in the North believe that Old Gnawbone had either left her lair or been slain, for the dragon hasn't been seen all summer.

In the morning the dwarves are incredibly efficient in packing and are ready to leave before dawn. They bid the PCs farewell before heading north towards Westbridge and Triboar.

IN RED LARCH

Red Larch stands on crossroads, where the Long Road is crossed by Khedell Path and the Cairn Road and is a popular stop for caravans. If the PCs reach the town shortly before or after nightfall the PCs might wish to find a place to stay. See Princes of the Apocalypse for a detailed description of Red Larch.

IN THE SWINGING SWORD

The Swinging Sword is the inn that most locals recommend the PCs to visit if they ask around. The inn is easy to find, it stands a short distance from the crossroads. Kaylessa Irkell, the owner of the Swinging Sword, welcomes the PCs and has many rooms available, standard PHB prices apply. She also invites the PCs to have a dinner in the dining room, where a roast lamb and potatoes are being served.

If the PCs decide to have a meal in the dining room, they will notice a few other guests. Most are merchants and caravan guards. A female half-elf sits in one corner, dressed like a ranger. This is Old Gnawbone or Claugiylamatar in a polymorphed form. The green dragon wyrm is interested in seeing what kind of mischief the alhoon is up to and has therefore not stepped in yet, confident in her own abilities. She firmly believes that Val'Xootis is no match for her. If the PCs talk with her, she is interested in hearing what they are up to.

The Swinging Sword's dining room is cozy and warm. The smell of cooked lamb and spiced potatoes brings water to your mouth. In one corner a young, blond haired minstrel plays softly on a lute and sings, his baritone voice in perfect balance with his music. There are a few merchants and caravan guards that sit by the two long tables in the dining room. Not far from the bard an half-elf in leather armor eats her lamb, she looks up as

you enter, her eyes green as a field of grass in high summer. Kaylessa invites you to sit where you want and says that food will come in a short while.

If the PCs wish to speak to the merchants or the caravan guards there are few news to learn. All the caravans are headed south to Waterdeep and for most of the guards there, this is the last caravan this summer, since winter is almost upon them.

If the PCs wish to speak to the bard, he gladly greets them. His name is Nomilar and hails from Neverwinter. He plans to hitch a ride with some of the caravans southwards, for he plans to visit Candlekeep. Nomilar doesn't know much about what's happening in Kryptgarden Forest, he has heard the caravan guards mention that they have spotted undead south of the forest and that the goblins seem especially weak this year.

If the PCs wish to speak to the half-elf, she introduces herself as Lia (see Ancient Green Dragon MM p. 94). Every question the PCs ask her she turns back into a question, and takes control of the conversation, in hope of learning as much as possible about the PCs. With a successful **DC 21 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that there's something more to Lia. Once she gets the feeling that the PCs suspect her or have begun asking questions she stands up and bids the PCs farewell.

Lia has a heavy pouch in her belt. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs notice her leather pouch and that is full of coins. Claugiylamatar wants the PCs to spot the pouch and take it, since the pouch contains a *Spy Stone* (see appendix) disguised as a gold coin. With a successful **DC 10 Dexterity (Sleight of hand) check** the PCs manage to steal the pouch. Old Gnawbone is interested to see how the PCs fare in their adventures and eager to know if she can somehow exploit them to further her own goals. Beside the Spy Stone the pouch contains 53 gp and 12 sp.

If the PCs ask Lia about Kryptgarden forest, she know the woods alarmingly well, e.g. if the PCs mention their encounter with the Blackshields, Lia will know Drungi and speak about the goblin leader as someone she has known for a long time. If the PCs tell Lia anything about their quest or mention Ravenhold, she'll tell the PCs that the tower has been abandoned for some years now, but she was always interested in know what was hidden in the dungeons beneath the old tower. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs get the feeling that there's something more this Lia isn't telling them everything. Lia however leaves the PCs and bids them farewell and good luck on their quest.



TRAVELLING TO AMPHAIL

It's a three days ride to Amphail. Roll for random encounters as you see fit, using the encounter table provided here above.



AMPHAIL AND BEYOND

The PCs find Anabel's house and depending on their travel speed they either find Anabel in her hut or her body in the stone circle not far from her home. Either way, the PCs need to track back and find Caser's burial mound, where Garmund and Yiriala await them, but so do the servants of Kirial.

ANABEL'S HUT

Anabel Stonesinger, N Shield Dwarf druid of the Circle of the Stone (see appendix), lives in a small hut an hour's ride north of Amphail. Her hut is about a mile east of the Long Road and not far from it stands a stone circle. Anabel is a former member of Garmund's adventuring company and after the fight with Kirial she settled in Dessarin Vale.

Read or paraphrase the following:

You follow the hastily drawn map that Garmund gave you until you finally see a small hut standing at the foot of a small hill. The hut has thatched roof but is made of stone and from the look of it, as sturdy as moderately sized keep. It's getting late in the day and the Sword Mountains cast their long shadows over the fields around you.

With a **DC 15 Intelligence (Stonecunning) check** the PCs know that the stones used in building the

hut were magically shaped, but there's also a great deal of dwarven craftsmanship in how they were put together.

What the PCs find inside the hut depends on how long their trip was. If their trip took more than 8 days they find the hut completely empty, but evidence will lead towards the stone circle where they will discover the withered body of Anabel. If their trip took less than 8 days they will be there when Kirial's shadow and wight minions attack the druid and get a chance to save her life.

If the PCs' trip took less than 8 days

The PCs find Anabel in her hut, where she is preparing lunch. She isn't too keen on having visitors. With a successful **DC 13 Charisma (Persuasion) check** the PCs manage to convince Anabel that they are friends and need to speak to her. If the PCs mention Garmund and Yiriala or Kirial they have an advantage on the roll. If a member of the Emerald Enclave is with the PCs, the roll is unnecessary, for Anabel will be more friendly to other members of that faction.

She invites the PCs in and to join her for lunch. She then asks the PCs to tell her everything that has transpired since they came to Triboar. She will ask many questions about the PCs; where are you from,



what is your company's name, what is your relation to Triboar, how do you know Garmund etc.; and she will also ask profoundly about the night when Olaf was caught by Kirial.

As night falls and lunch turns to late night talk drinking honey mead, Kirial's shadow and wight minions attack. The undead approach from west.

As you sit by in the warmth of the roaring fire in the fireplace in Anabel's hut, you suddenly feel a sharp decline in temperature. The shadows seem to darken and grow longer, the air has a faint odor of rot and decay and you can feel the hair on your hands rise. You look around. Anabel rises in her seat, looking at you: "I feel it too," she says and grabs her maul.

If the PCs look outside, with a successful **DC 16 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs spot dark shapes moving towards the hut. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Perception) check** the PCs hear words muttered on the wind, a dark voice spurting out foul litanies and urging whoever is out there to kill Anabel. The PCs recognize the voice as the voice of the creature that kidnapped Olaf.

Outside the hut is one of Kirial's **wights** (see MM p. 300), accompanied by 5 **shadows** (see MM p.

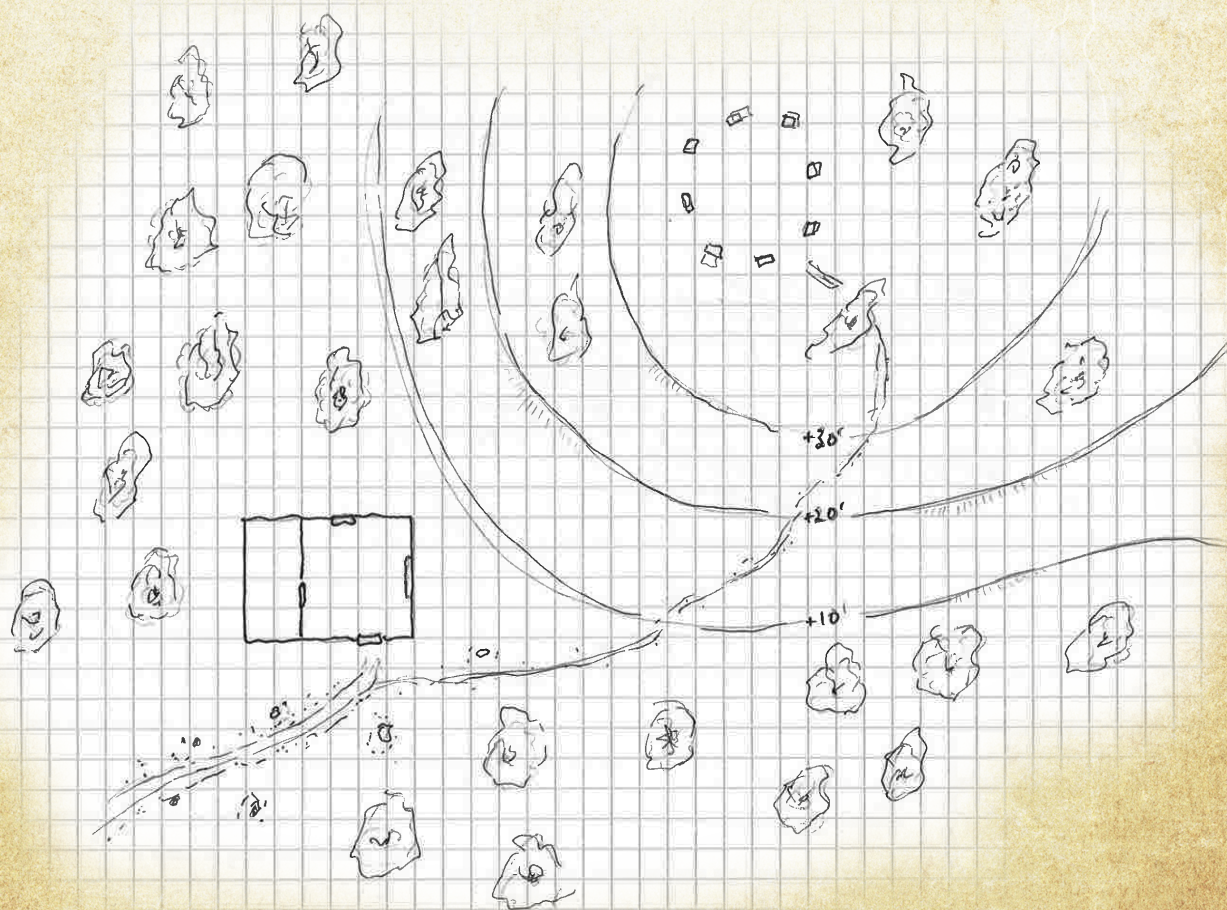
269). The wight sends the shadows in first, since the monsters are not hindered by closed doors. Once the first shadow has entered the hut, Anabel urges the PCs to follow her towards the stone circle through the backdoor. If the PCs follow her, she will make a stand in the circle. She will use Plant Growth and Spike Growth to slow the undead.

The wight and the shadow will fight to death, focusing their attacks on Anabel, since Kirial ordered them to slay the druid. If the PCs manage to thwart the undead attack, Kirial will know it and send more undead to finish the job. Anabel will stand and fight to the death inside the menhir.

If the PCs' trip took more than 8 days

The PCs find the hut completely empty and the backdoor open. The front door is locked and can be open with a **DC 15 Dexterity check** and thieves tools. At first sight everything seems in order inside the hut. With a successful **DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation) check** the PCs spot that Anabel must have left in haste, since there's still honey mead in a mug by the fireplace and her cloak hangs on a peg by the front door. In a small box beside her bed is a pouch containing 327 gp and 24 sp. The box is unlocked.

If the PCs search around the house, with a





successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check** they spot a trail leading towards the stone circle, though the trail quickly vanishes into the thick undergrowth surrounding the menhir. With a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (Nature) check** the PCs realize that the grass and weeds in the hill where the stone circle stands, is much thicker than the grass in the fields. This is due to Anabel's use of Plant Growth, with a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs discover this.

If the PCs enter the stone circle, read or paraphrase the following:

As you enter the circle of rune-encrusted stones, you spot someone lying in the middle of the circle. It is the body of a female dwarf. Her eyes stare into the darkened sky, upon which Selune has started to ascend. Beside the dwarf is a heavy maul, the shaft broken. Her skin is gray and withered, as if the life was drained from her body.

Anabel made her final stand in the stone circle she built. The wight and the shadows killed her there, the wight had the final blow. With a successful **DC 16 Intelligence (Medicine) check** the PCs figure out that Anabel was killed by something other than a forceful blow. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs suspect that it had something to do with necromancy.

As the PCs are investigating Anabel's corpse, it stirs and rises as a zombie under the control of the wight that killed her, a lieutenant in Kirial's small undead army.

You stand there over the body of the dwarven druid. Her arm moves. Then her whole body shakes violently. After a short while she stops and rises before you, with a red and unholy gleam in its eyes. The dwarf cocks her head to one side and snarls.

The zombie attacks the PCs and fights to the death. With a successful **DC 18 Intelligence (Religion) check** the PCs know that humanoid killed by wights rise as zombies the following night.

BACK TO RED LARCH

The three days it takes to ride back to Red Larch, assuming that the PCs are still riding, do not roll for random encounters, if Anabel is with them. Kirial sends shadows to attack them every night, making sure that they do not get a full night's rest. The first night the undead warlock sends 6 **shadows** (see MM

p. 269), the second night he sends 7 **shadows**. After the PCs reach Red Larch he decides to ambush the PCs by Caser's burial mound.

While enroute to Red Larch Anabel tells the PCs more about Kirial and how the Banner of the Scales defeated the warlock. She explains how the group found the way to enter Ravenhold and how she, Garmund and Yiriala built the burial mound for Caser after the battle against the warlock.

If Anabel isn't with the PCs, the wight lieutenant that attacked and killed Anabel, ambushes the PCs in hope to further enlarge Kirial's small army by killing the PCs. He attacks the PCs shortly after midnight on the second day of travel. The **wight** (see MM p. 300) is accompanied by 6 **zombies** (see MM. 316), all merchants that the wight has killed. The zombies fight to the death but the wight knows when to press the charge and when to run to fight another day.

IN RED LARCH

If the PCs decide to spend a night in Red Larch they'll probably stay again in the Swinging Sword. Lia is no longer there, but they can learn, with a successful **DC 12 Charisma (Persuasion) check**, that Garmund and Yiriala passed through the village a couple of days ago.

The PCs can stock up and buy the needed equipment and rations. Feel free to add rumors and NPCs as you see fit.

TOWARDS CASER'S BURIAL MOUND

The trip towards Caser's burial is remarkably uneventful. They only encounter a pair of hungry **owlbears** (see MM p. 249), which perhaps explains why there aren't any other predators in the area.

Ever since you lost sight of Red Larch your trip has been uneventful. The small farms give away for rolling lands, which is slowly ascending towards the Sword Mountains. North of you the Kryptgarden reached from the mountains towards Triboar. South of you the smaller Westwood spreads out. You leave the Kheldell path and head out westwards towards the Caser's burial mound. The day passes uneventful, the area is silent and you see very few animals and birds. At dusk you start to look for a good place to camp.

With a successful **DC 14 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs find a good place to camp. If the PCs wonder about the number of animals, with a successful



DC 12 Intelligence (Nature) check they know that there should be more animals about. This is in line with what the goblins of Blackshield tribe have been experiencing due the the alhoon's arrival in Kryptgarden forest. Once the PCs have got a fire started and have made their camp a couple of very hungry and ferocious owlbear attack.

Snow starts to fall as you manage to get a fire going. You cook your dinner and get ready to turn in for the night. Suddenly something large rushes towards you. You see the firelight reflect in two pair of eyes, both north of your camp. The creatures are large, with owl-like beaks and massive claws on their feet. Owlbears.

The owlbears are 40 feet away. A PC with **Passive Perception 13** is not surprised in the first round when the beasts come rushing into the PCs camp. Both owlbears fight to the death.

With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check** the PCs can see that both owlbears are skinny, their hide thin and both beasts probably starving.

The night passes otherwise uneventful.

The next day the weather has turned foul, a cold wind blows from the north, blowing up snow making visibility mere 30 feet. With a successful **DC 16 Wisdom (Survival) check** the PCs manage to find the correct path towards Caser's burial mound. If Anabel is with the party they have an advantage to the roll.

CASER'S BURIAL MOUND

Caser burial mound rests in the side of a small hill not far from the southern-most part of Kryptgarden Forest. The surviving members of Garmund's adventuring company built the burial mound to commemorate Caser, the party's fighter, who was killed in the battle against Kirial in Ravenhold.

If the PCs arrive within 12 days after they leave Triboar they arrive before Garmund and Yiriala. If the PCs arrive 13-15 days after they leave Triboar Garmund and Yiriala arrive just ahead of them. If the PCs arrive later than 15 days after they leave Triboar they find Garmund gravely wounded resting by a tree not far from the burial mound, Yiriala nowhere to be seen.

Read or paraphrase the following:

Caser's burial mound is visible for miles. As you draw closer you see that the burial entrance is in the side of a small but steep grassy hill. The entrance is made of stone, and the door is open.

If Garmund and Yiriala arrive ahead of the PCs

If Garmund and Yiriala have already arrived, they have made a camp not far from the hill. If Anabel is with the PCs Garmund greets her warmly and the trio hugs and speaks together for a while, before turning to the PCs.

Garmund has already scouted the burial mound and tells the PCs that the crypt reeks of the undead. The three of them designed and built the burial mound and can describe it in detail, if the PCs wish to ask questions. Refer to the description below. If the PCs ask why the barrow is open, neither Garmund or Yiriala know, since they haven't entered the burial chamber.

Once the PCs have asked all their questions, Garmund suggests that they press on and try to get closer to Ravenhold. He and Yiriala quickly gather their equipment and get ready to leave.

Just as you are about to head out once again, a shrill scream echoes from the burial mound. "No, mom, no, please don't leave me!" Yiriala's face turns white. She leans forward and urges her mount to sprint towards the barrow. "I'm coming, Olaf," she calls. Garmund, too late, tries to grab Yiriala. "No, wait, it's a trap," he says. Cursing, he casts one haunted look at you, grabs his sword and follows his wife.

If the PCs decide to follow, Yiriala enters the barrow 2 rounds before they do. If Anabel is with them she doesn't hesitate and follows her friends into the crypt. If the PCs decide not to follow, Anabel curses their cowardice.

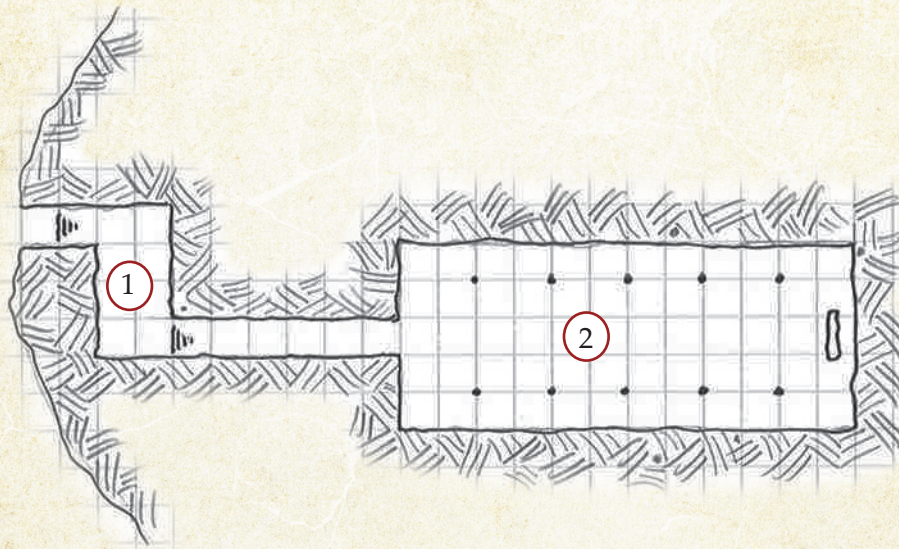
If the PCs arrive before Garmund and Yiriala

If the PCs arrived before Garmund and Yiriala they have time to inspect the burial mound for themselves. If they enter the burial chamber they will find Caser and his zombies there (see below).

Once Garmund and Yiriala arrive their meeting is the same as if Garmund and Yiriala had arrived first, except that Garmund hasn't investigated the hill where the burial mound is. They make camp with the PCs.

If the PCs arrive more than 15 days after leaving Triboar

If the PCs arrive too late, they find Garmund wounded lying by a tree not far from the burial mound. Garmund tells them that when they arrived, they found the barrow opened. They heard



Olaf calling them from inside and, against better judgement, rushed into the burial chamber, where they found their old comrade, Caser, in league with Kirial. Kirial stabbed Garmund and disappeared with Yiriala. Olaf is in the burial chamber, still standing where Kirial left him (see below).

Caser has been raised as an undead, a more powerful form of a zombie, Zombie Lord (see appendix) and is extremely dangerous.

Garmund begs the PCs not to enter the burial mound, for it might just kill them. If they insist he hands them his holy symbol and casts *Protection from Evil*. If they use any sort of healing magic his wounds seem slow to heal. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Insight) check** the PCs realise that Garmund spirit is broken, seeing his wife killed before his eyes was too much for him, especially with Kirial having kidnapped Olaf as well.

Garmund begs the PCs to save his son and wife from the monster that the warlock has become. He is sorry that he can't join them, but he is sincere and his only hope now is that his wife and son are freed from Ravenhold. He hands the PCs the things that Kirial formerly owned, the *Robe* and the *Wand*. He tells the PCs where to find Ravenhold and says: You can only enter the true tower by standing in its shadow on a moonlit night. The guardian will let anyone enter long as you look like Kirial and have some of his belongings.

THE BURIAL MOUND

Caser's burial mound was mostly built by Anabel, though Yiriala and Garmund took care of decorating the tomb and warding it. It is obvious to even non-dwarves that someone used magic, like Stone Shape, to form the chambers.

TOMB FEATURES

Unless otherwise noted the following are the tomb features. The tomb is well built by dwarven master stone masons and the corridors are wide and easy to traverse. With a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (Stonecunning) check** a dwarven PC quickly spots that the caves were built by dwarves and considerable time and effort was put into building the tomb, fitting a king.

FLOORS AND WALLS

The floors and walls are worked and even.

DOORS

There are no doors in the Burial Mound, save for the main entrance, which has been broken.

VISIBILITY AND LIGHT

Unless otherwise noted all halls and rooms are unlit and dark.



1. Foyer

Small stairway leads to the foyer. A pair of eight sided column stand by the stairs and the entrance to the antechamber. In one corner is a unlit brazier.

If the PCs are following Yiriala and Garmund, read or paraphrase the following:

You rush down a short flight of stairs into a darkened chamber. From a doorway in the other end of the room shines a faint blue and cold light. Strong rotting stench fills the air and you can feel that someone powerful in the Art summons energy. "Please, Kirial, don't harm Olaf," Yiriala's voice echoes from somewhere deeper in the tomb.

The other entrance leads down a 30' long hall into the burial chamber. Save from the cold, a green light that shines from Kirial's spell, *Wall of Fire*, which the warlock-wight cast to prevent the PCs to reach him in the burial chamber.

2. Burial chamber

The hall where Caser was laid to final rest is 60' long and 30' wide. The fighter's wooden coffin is in the other end. There are ten eight-sided columns in the chamber and unlit braziers in every corner.

Kirial has placed his spell, so that it reaches from one wall to the other, preventing the PC's to reach him. Kirial (see Appendix), Olaf and Caser (see Appendix) stand 15' away from the *Wall of fire*, 10' behind them are 4 **zombies** (see MM p. 315). Garmund and Yiriala stop 20' away from the wall, with only 5' between them.

You hurry down the hallway until you enter a large chamber with domed ceiling. Ten columns, five on each side, mark a hallway to a dais where an open wooden coffin stands. In the middle of the chamber is a curtain of blue and alien flames. On the other side stands the same dark hooded figure you saw in Triboar, the warlock Kirial. To his left stands a strong looking human wearing a rusted chainmail, holding a longsword, his skin pale and rotten. Kirial holds the boy Olaf with his left hand. The boy stands completely still and stares at his parents.

"Oh, see that, Caser, all your friends have arrived. What a lovely reunion this is," the warlock says, his voice echoing of the burial chambers walls. "I'm guessing that you must've decided to pay your dear old friend your respect while going to Ravenhold. I am looking forward to entertaining you as my guests."

"Begone, foul creature, the power of Kelemvor compels you!" Garmund calls out and presents the golden scales of the Lord of the Dead.

"Save your litanies, priest, they are worthless here," the warlock hisses. "I have a new patron, one that has granted me more power than you will ever wield, you puny doomguide."

"Please, Kirial," Yiriala pleads, clasping her hands together, "leave Olaf out of this. Take me instead."

"I thought you'd never ask," Kirial replies. He releases Olaf, summons arcane energy and vanishes in a silvery smoke. Before you can react he reappears between Yiriala and Garmund. He stabs Garmund.

With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs know the spell Kirial used as Misty Step.

In the first round of combat Caser calls his zombies to join him. A pair of **shadow mastiffs** (see VGM p. 190) step from the shadows and attack the PCs. If Anabel is with the PCs the mastiffs will target her in the first round. Kirial lightly touches Yiriala's shoulder and mutters a word in Draconic, activating his *Cape of the Mounteback*, stepping through the Dimension door. With a successful **DC 20 Intelligence (Arcana) check** the PCs recognize the magical item.

As soon as Kirial and Yiriala disappear the *Wall of Fire* dissipates and the zombies along with Caser attack.

All the undead and the mastiffs fight to the death. Caser is the only one holding any treasure. His sword is a *Lucksword*, but with no *Wishes*. This is potentially a very dangerous encounter, especially since Garmund is wounded and is of little help.

Olaf is in a near-catatonic state and stands perfectly still while the battle rages on. The Alhoon Val'Xootiz left an Intellect Devourer in Ravenhold, who devoured Olaf's intelligence, leaving him stunned and with Intelligence 0. Once the ability damage is healed Olaf can tell the PCs about the horrors of Ravenhold, which will be detailed in the next installment of the adventure path.

Garmund is terribly wounded and poisoned after Kirial's attack. He tries to help the PCs fight of the undead but he is too wounded to take part in the fight.

If Anabel is with the PCs she will shapechange into a bear and fight the mastiffs furiously.

Healing ability damage

Neither the Player's Handbook nor Dungeon Master's Guide have rules on how to heal ability



damage, save for the spell Greater Restoration. In most ability draining monsters abilities, e.g. the Shadow's Strength drain, you have included in the ability description information on how to regain or heal the ability damage. This is not the case with the Intellect Devourer's Devour Intellect ability. In this module it's proposed that Olaf heals all the damage to his intelligence after a long rest.

CONCLUSION

The PCs have helped Garmund save his son, but at a high cost. They know where to find and how to enter Ravenhold and could probably be easily swayed to follow the warlock wight to save Yiriala. Olaf can't help them locate Ravenhold, since he was unconscious and never saw how Kirial entered his lair.

If the PCs decide to go search for Ravenhold the story continues in next module, *Ravenhold*.



APPENDIX A:

NPCs

GARMUND

LN Human Cleric of Kelemvor

(see MM p. 348)

Description: Garmund is a dark haired Illuskan, his hair is thinning and graying, as is his beard, but his gray eyes are still full of life. Garmund usually wears a tabard embroidered golden scales of the Lord of the Dead. When adventuring he dons his chain shirt and has a longsword. Garmund is a serious man who takes his role as a Doomguide seriously.

Background: Born and raised in Shadowdale on a small farm, Garmund grew up listening to the stories told by the many adventurers stopping by the Old Skull Inn. As a kid he dreamed of being an adventurer and becoming famous. He especially loved to hear the tale about Midnight, Kelemvor and Adon, that brought the Tablets of Fate back to Lord Ao, and how they became gods. He was accepted as acolyte in the House of the Lady, but he decided to leave the temple only after a year, since he had chosen to follow a different dogma and he wanted to form an adventuring party. Two years later he formed the Banner of the Scales (see Adventure Background).

Bonds: Garmund is a devoted follower of Kelemvor, but in recent years he has become even more devoted to his family.

YIRIALA

NG Half-elf Bard

(see VGM p. 211)

Description: Yiriala is a beautiful woman, her golden hair flowing. She has the body of an elven lady but her temper is more kin to her human ancestry. Usually she was quick with a joke and jest, but Olaf's birth changed her. The former bard is soft spoken and has a warmth to her presence, still there's always

a hint of sorrow in her eyes. Yiriala wears a red robe over a chain shirt when adventuring and has a short box slung over her shoulder.

Background: Yiriala was born to human working woman in Arabel. Her mother was an alcoholic and never cared too much for Yiriala. She blamed her daughter for her position in life and constantly reminded Yiriala of it. As Yiriala turned 11 years old, her mother discovered that since herself wasn't that much of an attraction anymore, she could however earn some gold through selling access to her daughter. A few years later Yiriala ran from Arabel, 16 years later she then joined the Banner of the Scales. She never talks about these 16 years, which she spent roaming between taverns and inns in Cormyr, accepting gold for songs, poems and the trade she involuntarily learned from her mother.

Bonds: Yiriala loves Olaf and Garmund deeply and she will do anything for them. She is adamant in ensuring that Olaf does not experience the childhood horrors she did.

ANABEL

N Shield Dwarf Circle of the Stone Druid

(see MM p. 346)

Description: Anabel is pale skinned shield dwarf with a strong jawline and a stern look upon her face. She wears her brown hair in a thick braid. Her arms are thick and strong. Anabel is unlike many of her kin, since she is easy going and a good friend to those she trusts. She is wary of strangers. When adventuring she wears a leather apron (counts as leather armor) and is armed with a heavy maul, with a granite head.

Background: Anabel grew up in Thunderpeaks. Being the only child to her parents she learned her father's trade, masonry, and is an expert mason. Anabel venerates Sunnis, the elemental princess



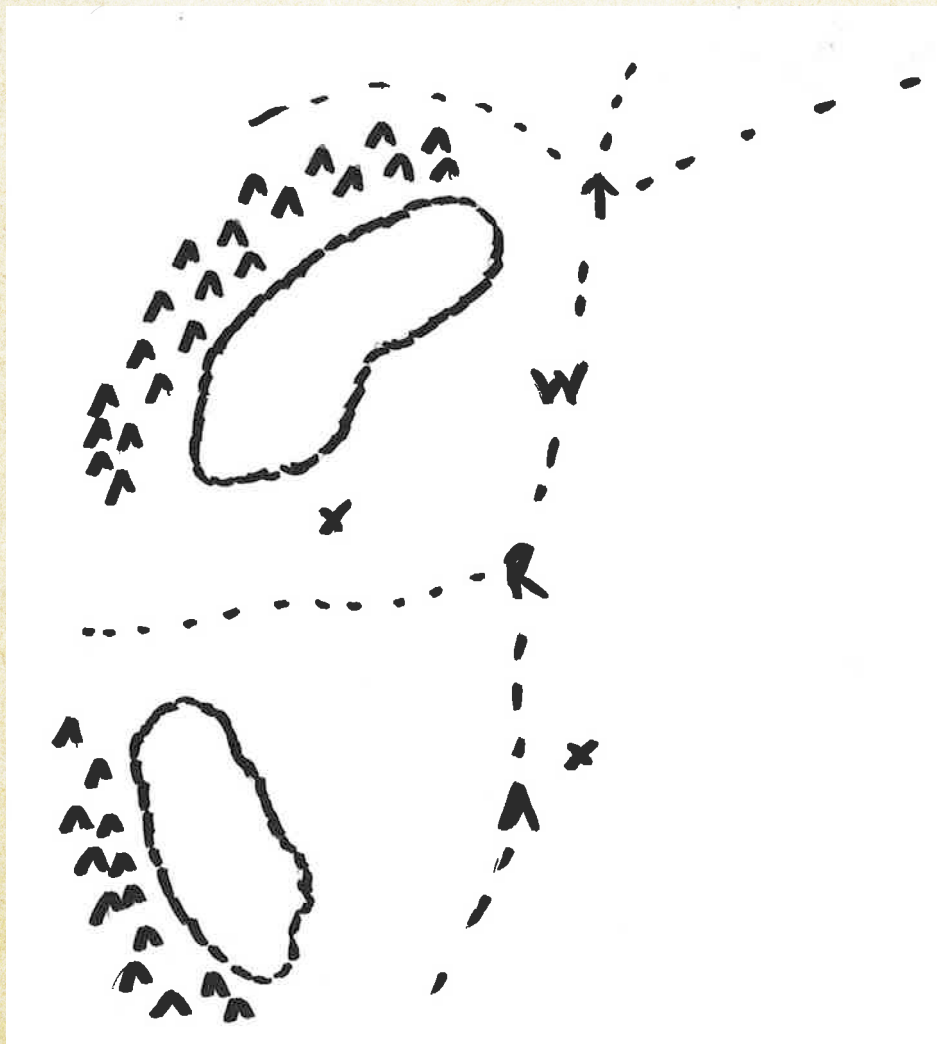
of good earth. After spending years toiling for her father, Anabel decided that it was time to leave her home in the Thunderpeaks. The first town she visited was Shadowdale, where she met Garmund and Yiriala and joined their adventuring party.

Bonds: Anabel is true to her friends. She has set her mind to erecting a stone circle for the glory of Sunnis on the hill above her hut.

APPENDIX B:

HANDOUT

YIRIALA'S HANDDRAWN MAP





APPENDIX B:

NEW MONSTERS

KIRIAL - WARLOCK WIGHT

When the alhoon Val'Xootis left the Underdark and found the Deeping Cave abandoned the undead set out to create his own legion. He started by searching the forest for candidates and found the remains of Kirial in Ravenhold. The mind-flayer lich raised the Kirial as a wight but due to the proximity to the Shadowfell the wight did not only return as a more powerful form of wight, but Kirial retained all his spellcasting abilities. Val'Xootis decided to make Kirial a captain in his army.

Kirial set about restoring Ravenhold to its former glory. Val'Xootis tasked Kirial with raising undead and enlarge the Alhoon's army. Val'Xootis has so far

not mentioned what his plans are to Kirial, though the warlock doesn't mind, since his mind is all set on having his revenge on the members of the Banner of the Scales.

Personality: Kirial is a petty and bitter figure. He hates knowing that Garmund managed to thwart his plans when he was still alive and is consumed with thirst to have his revenge. He plans on making sure that every member of the Banner of the Scales will suffer horribly.

Bonds: Kirial's spirit is bound to Ravenhold and he must return there to replenish his spells.

WARLOCK WIGHT

Medium undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 14 (Studded Leather)

Hit Points 45 (8d8 + 18)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	17 (+3)

Skills [Perception](#) +3, [Stealth](#) +4

Damage Resistances Necrotic; Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from Nonmagical Attacks that aren't Silvered

Damage Immunities Poison

Condition Immunities [Exhaustion](#), [Poisoned](#)

Senses [Darkvision](#) 60 ft., [Passive Perception](#) 13

Languages The languages it knew in life

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Innate Spellcasting. The warlock wight's innate spellcasting ability Charisma (spell save DC 13). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no verbal or material components.

At will: [detect magic](#), [disguise self](#), [mage armor](#)

Spellcasting. The warlock wight is a 6th level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with a spell attack). The warlock has 2 3rd level spells slots and knows the following spells:

Cantrips: [chill touch](#), [poison spray](#), [eldritch blast](#)

1st level: [arms of Hadar](#), [hex](#), [witch bolt](#)

2nd level: [misty step](#), [ray of enfeeblement](#)

3rd level: [hunger of hadar](#), [vampiric touch](#)

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the wight has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom ([Perception](#)) checks that rely on sight.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The warlock wight makes two longsword attacks or two longbow attacks. It can use its Life Drain in place of one longsword attack.

Necrotic Eldritch Blast. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 50 ft., one creature. Hit: 7 (1d10+3) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or be stunned for 1 round.

Life Drain. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

A humanoid slain by this attack rises 24 hours later as a [zombie](#) under the wight's control, unless the humanoid is restored to life or its body is destroyed. The wight can have no more than twelve zombies under its control at one time.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Longbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 150/600 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.



CASER - ZOMBIE LORD

One of the first thing Kirial did after returning from dead was to find out what had happened to the Banner of the Scales. He couldn't be happier when he found out that the group's fighter, Caser, was buried not far from Ravenhold. The wight found the burial mound and opened it. There he raised Caser as Zombie Lord and tasked the undead with waiting in the tomb for any member of the adventuring party and kill it. Kirial couldn't help but find it rather amusing if the zombie would manage to slay any of it's former partners.

Personality: In life Caser was a joyful and fun to hang around. He was a good and dear friend to his comrades. In undeath, the zombie lord is a hideous creature, disgusting monster that feels neither pain nor remorse. Caser, as zombie lord, is bound to obey Kirial.

It is useless to try to convince Caser not to attack or hurt his former comrades. As an undead Caser feels to solitary or companionship with his adventuring partners in life.

ZOMBIE LORD

Medium undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 13 Chain Mail

Hit Points 73 (9d8 + 27)

Speed 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	9 (-1)	6 (-2)	5 (-3)

Saving Throws CON +5, WIS +0

Damage Resistances Bludgeoning

Damage Immunities Poison

Condition Immunities Poisoned

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 8

Languages Languages that the zombie lord spoke in life

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Undead Fortitude. If damage reduces the zombie to 0 hit points, it must make a Constitution saving throw with a DC of 5 + the damage taken, unless the damage is radiant or from a critical hit. On a success, the zombie drops to 1 hit point instead.

Fetid Stench. Living creatures within 10 ft. of the Zombie Lord must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become *poisoned*.

Lord of the Dead. A zombie lord can as a bonus action direct one zombie within 30 feet to make an attack.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The zombie lord makes two attacks.

Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d8+5) slashing damage.

APPENDIX C:

NEW MAGICAL ITEM

SPY STONE

Wondrous item, rare

Spy stones come in pairs or trios, each a valuable gemstone. One of the stones is a master stone, while the others are spying stones.

While you touch the master stone, you can use an action to cast the Scrying spell from it, targeting a spying stone paired with the master stone (Save DC 17). The target is the bearer of the other stone. If no creature has the stone on her person, you know that fact as soon as you use the stone and don't cast the spell.

Once Scrying is cast through the stones, they can't be used again until next dawn. If one of the stones in the pair is destroyed, the other one becomes non-magical.



APPENDIX D:

NEW DRUID CIRCLE

BY HELGI MAR FRIDGEIRSSON

THE CIRCLE OF STONE

Druids that belong to the Circle of Stone are a surly lot, often dwarves or gnomes, that try to embody nature's permanence through rocks and stone. They are slow to anger and often keep to themselves or gather in small groups where they construct stone circles that augment natural places of power. They call upon the earth's magic to bolster their physical form and eventually to sustain them, even in the event of death.

Granite Skin: Starting at level 2, you can call upon the power of the stones to protect yourself. When you cast a level 1 or higher spell, you can use earthen magic to cover your skin in a protective layer of stone that lasts until you finish a long rest. The granite skin has hit points equal to twice your druid level + your Wisdom modifier. Whenever you take damage, the granite skin takes the damage for you. If this damage reduces the granite skin to 0 hit points, you take the remaining damage.

At 0 hit points, the granite can no longer absorb the damage, but its magic persists. Whenever you cast a level 1 or higher spell, the granite skin regains a number of hit points equal to twice the spell's level. Once you call your granite skin, you can not create new ones until you have completed a long rest.

Lore of Stone: Starting at level 2, you become proficient in History and Stonemasons Kit. If you are already proficient then you gain Expertise instead.

Defense of the Menhir: Starting at level 6, as a reaction when you take damage, you can cover yourself in stone, which crumbles away at the end of your next turn. You gain ten temporary hit points per druid level, which take as much of the trigger damage as possible. Immediately after you take the damage, you gain vulnerability to thunder damage, your speed is reduced to zero, and you are incapacitated. These effects, including any remaining temporary hit points, all end when the stone crumbles. Once you use this ability, you cannot use it again until you finish a long or short rest.

Sure-Footed: Starting at level 6 you have advantage on Strength and Dexterity saving throws made against effects that would knock you prone.

Congress of Stone: Starting at level 10 you gain Tremorsense 60' and can cast Commune as a spell like ability. The Commune contacts only Earth Domain deities. Once you use this ability, you can not use it again until you finish a short or long rest.

Menhir Haven: Starting at level 14 you can specially prepare a menhir in any area containing a majority of uncovered stone. This process takes 20+1d20 days and requires you to work on the menhir without interruptions from dawn till dusk. Once you complete the task this menhir now has your life force tied to it. You can seek shelter within it by merging with the stone, becoming immune to any effect while inside and while the menhir stands you reform inside it if killed within 1d20 days at dawn. While you are alive Tremorsense from Congress of Stone also covers the area around your Menhir Haven to a range of 60'. If your Menhir Haven is destroyed and you are alive at the time you can not begin to construct another for a year and a day.